

TABLE 6.2 : PERCENTAGE DISTRIBUTION OF ETHNIC GROUPS IN THE CENSUS YEARS

ETHNIC GROUPS	1881	1891	1901	1911	1921	1931	1946	1953	1963	1971
All Ethnic Groups	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
1. Sinhalese	66.9	67.9	65.7	66.1	67.0	65.3	69.4	69.3	70.9	72.0
Low Country	-	-	40.9	41.8	42.8	41.7	43.6	42.8	42.2	42.8
Kandyan	-	-	24.8	24.3	24.2	23.6	25.8	26.5	28.7	29.2
2. Tamils	24.9	24.0	26.6	25.8	24.9	26.6	22.7	23.0	22.8	20.5
Sri Lanka	-	-	-	12.9	11.5	11.2	11.0	11.0	11.1	11.2
Indian	-	-	-	12.9	13.4	15.4	11.7	12.0	11.7	9.3
3. Moors	6.7	6.6	6.4	6.5	6.4	6.1	6.2	6.3	6.5	6.7
Sri Lanka	-	-	-	5.7	5.7	5.4	5.6	5.7	6.0	6.5
Indian	-	-	-	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.6	0.6	0.5	0.2
4. Burghers & Eurasians	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.4	0.4
5. Malays	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
6. Veddhas	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	-	-
7. Europeans	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.1	-	-
8. Others	0.3	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.4	0.2	0.8

80

72